Good Writing Practices for REL 200

Exactness is a principle of the gospel. When we exercise this in all areas of your lives, we can realize an increase in the direction we receive from the Spirit. This can be demonstrated in the little things in our posts and other written assignments. This includes:

- Capitalizing the names of deity and people - God, Heavenly Father, Jesus Christ, Lord, Joseph Smith, Jane Doe, etc.
- Capitalizing second and third-person pronouns referring to Deity. For example:
  - Jesus and **His** disciples
  - When God create the earth, **He** did not create it out of nothing. *(Style Guide for Publications of the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints, (2013) 4th ed. 34).*
- Referring to General Authorities by their titles, such as President, Elder, or Sister. For example:
  - President Monson
  - Elder Holland
- Using good grammar and complete sentences.
- Using proper punctuation.
- Using a spell checker to be sure you are ready to post a well-thought-out paragraph or paper.
- Reading your post/assignment out loud to make sure it sounds well-written and cohesive, and adheres to the rubrics.
- Follow the approved citation methods for Church materials, listed in the table below.
- For further questions visit the official **Church Style Guide (https://drive.google.com/file/d/1YY-bT65XlqwhkbVcDXQayJh-LctjufEl/view)**.

Citation Formatting for REL 200

Type	Format	Examples
Scriptures	Give the full name of the book and chapter and verse. (However, references to verses in the Doctrine and Covenants can be abbreviated as D&C.) Only official Latter-day Saint editions of the scriptures should be quoted.	(1 Nephi 2:11). (Moses 1:21-22, 24, 23). (Matthew 12, chapter heading).
churchofjesuschrist.org	When citing documents that are published online, prefer those that have embedded page breaks, such as PDFs.	(*Providing in the Lord's Way: A Leader's Guide to Welfare* [1990], 5, providentliving.org). ("Agency," Gospel Topics, topics.churchofjesuschrist.org).

	No page number is given unless the text is available as a PDF. Provide only the main website address if the reader can find the document easily from the main page of the website. If the reader cannot find the document easily, it may be better to provide the complete address. The fourth example shows how to quote an excerpt from an outside source (Henry B. Eyring) that is part of the article.	("How do I keep my covenant to always remember the Savior?" *Come, Follow Me: Learning Resources for Youth* [Sunday School curriculum], churchofjesuschrist.org/youth/learn). (Henry B. Eyring, in "Today's Family: Love Your Wife," churchofjesuschrist.org/prophets-and-apostles/unto-all-the-world/love-your-wife).
Conference Talks	Use the first format for general conference talks given November 2002 forward. From that issue onward, the pagination and text for general conference issues are the same in the *Ensign* and the English *Liahona*. Use the second format for general conference talks given 1971 through 2002, citing only the *Ensign.* Use the third format for general conference talks given before 1971. For citing materials that are published only online, generally use the standard magazine citation format. However, for ease of use, you can use the fourth format and cite the general conference talk directly.	(Thomas S. Monson, "A Sacred Trust," *Ensign* or *Liahona*, May 2016, 85). (Gordon B. Hinckley, "Overpowering the Goliaths of Our Lives," *Ensign*, May 1983, 46). (Marion G. Romney, in Conference Report, Apr. 1961, 117). (Joseph B. Wirthlin, "Finding a Safe Harbor," Apr. 2000 general conference).
Church Magazine Articles	Some articles in the *Ensign*, *New Era*, and *Friend* are also in the *Liahona*. These articles	(Clifford E. Young, "We Will Not Turn Back," *Ensign*, July 2011, 47). ("A Fireside Chat on a Burning Question," *Relief Society Magazine*, Jan.

	should be cited only to the *Ensign*, *New Era*, or *Friend* except when citing conference talks from November 2002 forward.	1958, 35-36).
Proclamations	When quoting from "The Family: A Proclamation to the World" or "The Living Christ: The Testimony of the Apostles," use the references from the *Ensign* and *Liahona*.	("The Family: A Proclamation to the World," *Ensign* or *Liahona*, Nov. 2010, 129). ("The Living Christ: The Testimony of the Apostles," *Ensign* or *Liahona*, Apr. 2000, 2).
Devotionals and Firesides	Use the first format for devotionals and firesides at Brigham Young University. The text for most BYU devotionals and firesides is available at speeches.byu.edu. When quoting from these talks, cite that website as shown. Use the second format for devotionals given at Brigham Young University-Idaho. No page number is given unless the text is available in PDF. The text in brackets should reflect the information the website provides about the talk, whether it was given in a devotional or a fireside. If a PDF is available on the website, include the page number in the citation. If the text is available in HTML only, cite the talk without a page number.	(Spencer W. Kimball, "Be Ye Therefore Perfect" [Brigham Young University devotional, Sept. 17, 1974], 4, speeches.byu.edu). (Dallin H. Oaks, "Be Wise" [Brigham Young University-Idaho devotional, Nov. 7, 2006], byui.edu).
REL 200 Podcasts	To cite the podcasts used in this course, include "Podcast", "U3P1", and the title of the section where it is located.	(Podcast, U3P1, Section Title).
Books	When citing entries from reference works (such as	(*Merriam-Webster's Collegiate Dictionary*, 11th ed. [2003], "salvation").

dictionaries or encyclopedias) follow the capitalization of the entry in the original.

When citing a hymn from *Hymns*, refer to the hymn number rather than the page number. Use abbreviation *no.* in the source citation. When referring to other collections of Church hymns or the *Children's Songbook*, use page numbers.

Citations for books include the author's name, the title of the book (in italics), the year it was published, and the page number you are referencing.

Pamphlets and booklets must include the type of document in the citation, as well as the name, year of publication, and page number.

("I Know That My Redeemer Lives," *Hymns*, no. 136).

("A Child's Prayer," *Children's Songbook*, 12-13).

(David A. Bednar, *Increase in Learning*, 2011, 23)

(*For the Strength of Youth* [booklet, 2001], 14).

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